



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

śoka-paṅka-nimagnaṃ yaḥ sāṅkhya-yogopadeśataḥ |
ujjahārārjunaṃ bhaktaṃ sa kṛṣṇa-śaraṇaṃ mama ||
jñānaṃ karma ca vispaṣṭam aspaṣṭam bhaktim uktavān |
ataevāyam adhyāyaḥ śrī-gītā-sūtram ucyate ||
iti sārārtha-varṣiṇyāṃ harṣiṇyāṃ bhakta-cetasām |
śrī-gītāsu dvitīyo 'yaṃ saṅgataḥ saṅgataḥ satām ||2||

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verses 1-2

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine Arjuna, overwhelmed by sorrow and confusion, sinking deep into a mire of despair. This is the 'śoka-paṅka,' the mud of grief, a state we all know intimately when faced with life's daunting challenges. It is in this vulnerable space that Krishna, the divine charioteer and friend, steps in, offering the wisdom of Sāṅkhya and Yoga. These are not mere philosophical systems, but practical tools to navigate the complexities of existence and release yourself from the grip of suffering.

Krishna's role is pivotal; He uplifts Arjuna, pulling him from the depths of despair through divine guidance. This act symbolizes the potential within each of us to rise above our own personal battles when we surrender to a higher power, a guiding principle, or simply our own inner wisdom. The passage highlights that while knowledge and action are clearly defined paths, devotion (bhakti) remains somewhat veiled. This suggests that devotion is not simply ritualistic worship, but a subtle, underlying current of love and surrender that permeates all aspects of your life.

The verses then declare this particular chapter as the essence, the 'sūtra,' of the Gītā itself, a compact summary of its core teachings. This chapter, like a thread, weaves together the various strands of wisdom that will unfold in the chapters to come. It is a source of joy for those with devoted hearts, a companion for sincere seekers of truth. In modern life, we often find ourselves similarly mired in the mud of our own making – anxieties, fears, and uncertainties. Just as Krishna guided Arjuna, the teachings of the Gītā offer you a path to self-discovery and liberation from these self-imposed limitations. The key is to cultivate devotion, not as blind faith, but as a deep-seated trust in the universe and your own potential for growth.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you identify the 'śoka-paṅka' in your own life and begin to apply the wisdom of Sāṅkhya and Yoga to find clarity and inner peace?